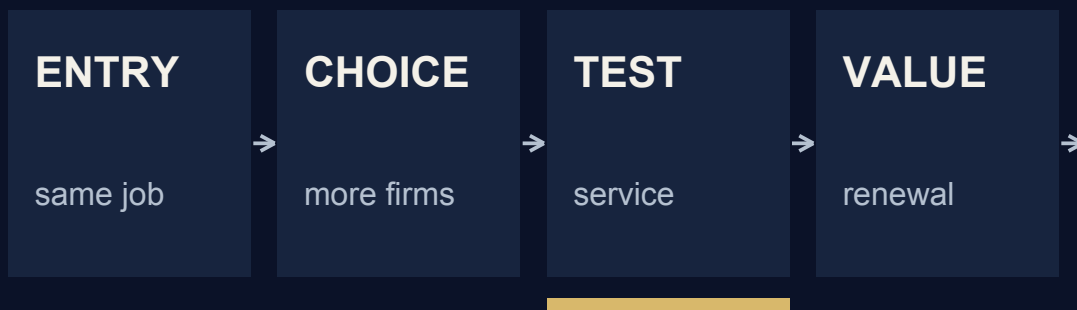


When the badge becomes common

The permission that opens a market could also open it to your rivals.

IF CUSTOMERS HAVE USABLE ALTERNATIVES



Permission gets you into the comparison.

This is a thought experiment, not a reported effect of the trust-bank lawsuit.

What would keep the customer paying?

Keep the legal question separate.

The documents establish positions, not the commercial outcome.

OCC POSITION

Clarifying authority

The agency describes the 2026 rule as a clarification.

Individual licensing review remains.

ICBA COMPLAINT

Challenging the framework

The October 2 complaint asks the court to set aside agency actions.

No court outcome is established here.

No current operating authority of a named firm is certified.

A requested remedy is not a granted remedy.

Two suppliers. One eligible service.

Assume A and B have equivalent permission for the same custody service.

SUPPLIER A

Shows the charter in every sales slide.

SUPPLIER B

Shows reconciliation and a complete exit file.

CUSTOMER COMPARISON

Can either demonstrate useful service?

Both feed a comparison. B has not won a test or earned a premium.

The badge alone cannot explain a higher price.

Give both firms the same messy record.

Proposed small exercise, using invented data only.

01

Same discrepancy

Can they explain and resolve the missing entry?

02

Same deadline

Record time and staff effort.

03

Same exit request

Check completeness of the exported record.

04

Full quoted cost

Compare the entire service scope.

No customer data, live transfers or provider access was used.

Compare the work behind the sales pitch.

Staying can mean two different things.

A renewal is useful evidence, but its cause still matters.

USEFUL INTEGRATION

Worth keeping

The service saves work the customer values.

Repeatability and cost coverage still need evidence.

DIFFICULT MIGRATION

Hard to leave

The customer may stay because moving is painful.

Retention alone does not prove satisfaction.

Neither explanation is assigned to a real company here.

An exit test helps; it does not measure every switching cost.

Turn from the charter to the invoice.

If another firm can lawfully do the same job, why choose this one again?

ENTRY QUESTION

Can this firm offer the service?

Why would the customer renew?

Scarce eligibility or impractical switching could weaken the hypothesis. Check actual alternatives, repeatable service and full costs.

No provider costs, renewal data or investment returns are estimated.

Test what remains valuable after permission is shared.

The evidence and the imagined market.

Documents support the legal context. The customer story is a thought experiment.

S1 **OCC chartering bulletin**

2026-02-27

S2 **National Bank Chartering final rule**

2026-03-02

S3 **ICBA complaint against OCC**

2026-10-02

S4 **October 5 source Special**

2026-10-05

Bounded review did not verify a resolving court order. It does not prove none exists.

No lawsuit outcome or business advantage is established.